



From left: PoornaChandra Suraj, Artist; Vikram Parthan, Level Designer

The buzz and the high of creation... there is nothing like it in the whole world!" gushes Ashray.

"The fact that you can create digital content within a massive game world, own it and then sell it in the real world means that boundaries between simulation and real life are blurring. And gaming as an industry has been at the forefront of this crossover".

No gaming company in India has developed more resources under their roof than Raptor: a weapons engine, a camera engine, a particle/composite-particle engine, a physics engine, a character engine, a terrain-rendering engine, a sound engine, a shadow engine and a scripting engine, all created inhouse.

Architect-in-chief Sandeep, is responsible for research, development and engineering of the 'XForce Engine'. How does the XForce (XF) stack up against engines that power internationally renowned behemoths such as DOOM III and Half-Life 2? The XF Engine is good, but as Vidyuth puts it, "Doom III and Half-Life 2 have too much technology for us to implement with our limited budget... we do hope to get there someday. The XF Engine cannot be compared to those but most certainly can be compared to the likes of the X-Ray Engine and the Crytek Engine." The XF Engine also implements shaders and volumetric shadows, "Technologically, things are advancing at a very rapid pace," says Sandeep, "...staying in sync, is one of the most challenging tasks!"

Driven By Passion

Raptor hopes to continue to build high-quality games; future plans include taking their creation(s) to consoles. There are also plans of

licensing their engine, "One of the main constraints that have plagued growth of game development in India is the time and money consumed in setting up your technical platform. The quicker approach of licensing a quality game engine is almost unaffordable.

In the future, we plan to license our engine to fellow Indian developers at extremely nominal costs", says Sandeep. This is definitely good news and we hope he follows-up on this plan as affordable tools are of paramount importance to Indian developers.

"If the BPO sector of gaming such as Sound Design and Production can be developed in India over a given period; it will bring down costs drastically," says Vidyuth. "I see India's cost-effectiveness playing a huge part in the progress of this industry."

Making a game is a gargantuan investment in cash (A good international title is often budgeted to cost a few million dollars). What is more impressive then is that Raptor Entertainment is completely self-funded. Sandeep: "Managing a team of 14 is certainly difficult, especially with funding coming from our own pockets! I must thank my dad, Mr. Narasimhan, for understanding our wavelengths and being generous in helping us through our tight situations."

The other side of being financially independent is that they do not have a single game release to their name in the more than three years of their existence. Will Raptor be able to sustain itself until the time their game is released? They certainly have the passion to see it through.

The fervour and dedication that the 14 possess is evident as Sandeep speaks of hard times. He looks back at times when the team worked its "backside off" without taking any money home.

"We would skip a meal a day and work! The team never lost its drive or focus, (adversities) just made us look the challenge of making a world-class game, in the face." They will need that fire to sustain themselves as time progresses. Creating a game is no play but we have faith in our boys from Bangalore. Go get 'em, Raptor! ☒

Xtreeme Forces is scheduled for a worldwide release towards the end of 2005.



From left: Sudhir G N & Ravindra Kumar, Technical Engineers

Write In

Assembled something just as geeky? Tell us about it. Write to editor@thinkdigit.com